

SOP-ET-005 REV 2: Confined Space Entry - TK-401 Equalization Tank

Standard Operating Procedure SOP-ET-005 Revision: 2 Effective date: 2023-05-20

Title: Confined Space Entry - TK-401 Equalization Tank

Supersedes: SOP-ET-005 rev 1

PROCEDURE STEPS:

1. Obtain confined space entry permit (PTW) authorized by Safety Officer.
2. Isolate TK-401: blind inlet and outlet lines, LOTO P-107.
3. Drain and flush tank; remove sludge as far as practicable from outside.
4. FORCED VENTILATION / AIR PURGE: run eductor for MINIMUM 4 HOURS before entry. Do not shorten purge for schedule reasons (ref near-miss NM-2019-07, NM-2022-31).
5. Gas test by competent person: O₂ 19.5-23.5%, H₂S < 10 ppm, LEL < 5% - IMMEDIATELY BEFORE entry and REPEAT EVERY 30 MINUTES during work.
6. CAUTION: disturbing settled sludge can re-release H₂S even after a passing initial gas test. Continuous monitor mandatory inside.
7. Standby attendant at manway at all times; rescue tripod rigged.
8. Entry log maintained; permit closed on exit.

HAZARDS: H₂S from sludge; oxygen deficiency; engulfment.

Approved by: Plant Manager, Unit 4